

FATEMA T. JOHRA

Incident Response | Cyber Defense | Digital Forensics (DFIR) | Federal Cybersecurity

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Active Security Clearance | U.S. Citizen | Federal Contractor

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Incident response and digital forensics professional with 7+ years of experience in federal cybersecurity and cyber defense, nearly all of it as a federal contractor supporting the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC) across two roles. Work spans the full incident lifecycle - detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident reporting - across AWS, Azure, Microsoft 365, and enterprise environments, in line with NIST SP 800-61, NIST SP 800-53, and MITRE ATT&CK. Built our incident response readiness program from the ground up: designed and launched a bi-annual incident response test, wrote the CSIRT SOP, Incident Response Plan, and IR Policy, and established the response playbooks the team relied on. Hands-on experience across SIEM, EDR/XDR, and forensic platforms, with a track record of training new employees and coordinating cross-functionally with SOC analysts, engineers, and infrastructure teams during active incidents. Skilled in translating technical findings into executive-ready reporting for leadership.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Incident Response & SOC: SOC Alert Triage • Incident Response (IR) • Incident Lifecycle Management • Containment • Eradication • Recovery • Root Cause Analysis • Threat Detection • Threat Hunting • Threat Intelligence • IOC Analysis • TTP Mapping • Security Event Analysis • Log Correlation

Digital Forensics: DFIR • Security Investigations • Host & Network Forensics • Evidence Collection & Chain of Custody • Malware Analysis • Memory & Volatile Forensics • Forensic Tool Validation

Tools & Platforms: Splunk (Enterprise Security) • Fidelis • CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR) • Microsoft Defender XDR • Cortex XDR • Ironport • Archer • Magnet AXIOM • ServiceNow • BMC Remedy

Cloud & Enterprise Security: AWS • Microsoft Azure • Microsoft 365 • Enterprise Security • Endpoint Security • Identity & Access Management (IAM)

Governance & Reporting: CSIRT SOPs • Incident Response Plans • Risk Assessment • Tabletop Exercises & After-Action Reports • Operational Readiness • Executive Reporting • SITREPs • Cross-Functional Collaboration • New Employee Training

Frameworks & Compliance: NIST SP 800-53 • NIST SP 800-61 • FISMA • OMB Guidance • MITRE ATT&CK

Scripting: Python • PowerShell

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Information Assurance & Network Specialist | CODEplus LLC (Federal Contractor - U.S. NRC)

Sep 2020 - Sep 2025

- Triaged and investigated 10-15 security alerts and up to 20-30 phishing emails daily using Splunk and Fidelis, correlating events across SIEM, cloud, and network platforms to identify indicators of compromise (IOCs) and map tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs) to MITRE ATT&CK
- Tuned EDR and IDS detection rules to reduce false positives, and performed malware triage and memory/volatile forensics on compromised endpoints to support root cause analysis
- Acted as incident lead for 2-3 major security incidents per week across AWS, Azure, Microsoft 365, and enterprise environments, directing response from validation and scoping through containment, eradication, recovery, and closure, resolving most within one hour
- Coordinated incident handling activities with infrastructure, cloud, and security teams during active investigations, maintaining clear documentation and situational awareness from initial triage through resolution
- Reviewed AWS and Azure authentication logs and access authorization to spot anomalous activity, validate indicators of compromise, and support root cause analysis and attack vector determination
- Owned the CSIRT SOP, Incident Response Plan, IR Policy, Test Plan, and response playbooks, keeping documentation current, audit-ready, and aligned to NIST incident response methodology
- Designed and launched a bi-annual incident response test from the ground up - built the scenarios, observed team responses in real time, and authored the After-Action Report (AAR) with root cause findings, lessons learned, and remediation tracking
- Trained new employees on incident response procedures and tools, and worked alongside SOC analysts, engineers, and deskside support teams to coordinate incident handling and resolution
- Trained to maintain the Archer GRC server, including backups and updates, and maintained the Archer disaster recovery plan documentation

- Wrote incident reports, executive briefings, and status updates for leadership, and logged and tracked cases using ServiceNow and BMC Remedy
- Managed quarterly phishing simulation campaigns for 3,000+ users, tracked who clicked links or opened attachments, and reported the results

Security Coordinator | Business Integra (Federal Contractor - U.S. NRC)

Jul 2019 - Sep 2020

- Investigated security events, analyzed indicators of compromise, and documented findings for a federal regulatory client
- Maintained and updated the CSIRT SOP, IR Plan, IR Policy, and IR Test Plan annually and bi-annually, and kept access controls set correctly on internal SharePoint and ADAMS
- Supported IAM reviews across AWS and Azure and coordinated remediation with technical teams
- Coordinated response between technical and security teams during investigations and wrote reports for compliance reviews and audits

Graduate Research Assistant - Digital Forensics & Incident Response | George Mason University

Sep 2018 - May 2020

- Developed forensic evidence correlation methods, automated forensic workflows, and tested forensic tools, including host forensic analysis using Magnet AXIOM
- Wrote technical documentation for digital forensics research and evidence analysis

Digital Forensics Intern | DHS Cyber Crime Center (C3)

Jun 2018 - Sep 2018

- Acquired and analyzed endpoint, mobile, cloud, and macOS evidence to support digital forensic investigations, maintaining chain of custody throughout
- Supported active forensic investigations and evidence processing

PROJECTS

- Incident Response Portfolio: playbooks, CSIRT procedures, executive reports, and tabletop exercises built on NIST and CISA guidance
- SOAR Phishing Response Playbook: a standard workflow for phishing triage, containment, remediation, and reporting
- Digital Forensics Investigation Lab: forensic analysis using Magnet AXIOM, evidence handling, and reporting documentation

EDUCATION

- Master of Science, Digital Forensics and Incident Response | George Mason University | May 2020
- Bachelor of Science, Applied Information Security | George Mason University | May 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500) | In Progress
- CompTIA CySA+ (Planned) | AWS Certified Security (Planned)

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Offensive Security PWK/OSCP coursework | Completed
- Continuous hands-on labs in DFIR, cloud security, and incident response